

MacroWatch Data Reference

Complete Cheat Sheet — Every Indicator, Legend, Signal & Dalio Significance

Living document — updated as new indicators are added | v1.1-stable | May 8, 2026

Universal Color Code

GREEN — Healthy / Normal / No immediate concern

YELLOW — Caution / Monitor / Borderline **RED** — Warning / Stress / Action Required

Important: For some indicators, UP is bad (VIX rising = more fear, Dealer Takedown rising = stress). For others, UP is good (BTC rising = stronger demand). The color code always reflects whether the situation is healthy or stressed — not simply the direction of movement. Read the legend for each indicator.

DAILY Tab

Regime Signals (top of Daily tab — derived indicators)

Signal	Formula	Green = Healthy	Red = Warning	Dalio Meaning
Term Premium	10Y yield minus 2Y yield	STEEPENING	FLATTENING / INVERTED	Inverted = market pricing recession. Steepening after inversion = late-cycle transition. Currently: +0.49% steepening.

Liquidity	SPX ÷ Fed Broad USD Index	EXPANDING	CONTRACTING	Rising = risk assets outperforming dollar = growth regime. Falling = flight to safety, dollar strength = risk-off.
Gold/Yield	Gold price ÷ 10Y yield	NORMAL	DISTRUST	High ratio = market distrusting paper assets, pricing in currency debasement. At 1,084 = elevated distrust signal. Classic Dalio late-cycle warning.

Metals & Commodities

Indicator	Source	Refresh	Signal Interpretation
Gold (XAU/USD)	gold-api.com	Real-time	UP = inflation hedge demand, reserve currency distrust, geopolitical stress. All-time highs (\$4,700+) = late-cycle Dalio warning. Gold at ATH while Fed holds rates = market pricing future monetization.
Silver (XAG/USD)	gold-api.com	Real-time	Tracks gold but has industrial demand component. Gold/Silver ratio rising = pure risk-off (gold outperforming). Ratio falling = industrial demand recovering = growth signal.
WTI Crude (USD/bbl)	OilPriceAPI.com	~30 min	UP = inflation pressure, reduces Fed ability to cut. DOWN sharply (e.g., -10%) = demand destruction OR geopolitical easing (e.g., Iran deal May 6). Highly correlated with headline CPI. Watch for sustained moves above \$110 or below \$75.
Brent Crude (USD/bbl)	OilPriceAPI.com	~30 min	Global benchmark. Brent premium over WTI = geopolitical/supply disruption. Watch Hormuz risk premium. Brent and WTI should move in same direction — divergence signals market dislocation.

FX & Volatility

Indicator	Source	Refresh	Legend / Signal Interpretation
Fed Broad USD <i>Not ICE DXY</i>	FRED (DTWEXBGS)	Daily	Fed's trade-weighted dollar index vs 26 currencies. Reads ~118 (NOT the headline ICE DXY ~98 — different methodology). Rising = dollar strengthening broadly. UP is bad for EM debt, commodities, foreign capital flows into UST.
EUR/USD	open.er-api.com	Hourly	Falling = dollar strengthening. Below 1.05 = significant dollar strength. Above 1.20 = dollar weakness. EUR/USD inversely correlated with ICE DXY (EUR has 57.6% weighting in DXY).
USD/JPY	open.er-api.com	Hourly	Rising = yen weakening. BOJ intervention threshold historically ~150-160. Watch: if Japan must sell UST to defend yen, that's direct Dalio foreign selling signal. Currently 156.61.
VIX Fear Index	FRED (VIXCLS)	1-day lag	< 15 Complacent 15-20 Normal 20-30 Elevated 30-40 Fear >40 Extreme Fear Low VIX (e.g., 17) despite deteriorating macro = dangerous complacency. VIX spikes rapidly — watch for fast move above 30.

Treasury Yields

Indicator	Source	Signal Interpretation
2-Year Note	FRED (1-day lag)	Most sensitive to near-term Fed expectations. 2Y rising = market pricing higher rates longer. 2Y falling ahead of Fed = cut expectations building. Currently 3.87%.
10-Year Note	FRED (1-day lag)	Global benchmark for mortgages, corporate debt, discount rates. Above 5% = serious debt sustainability risk at 122% Debt/GDP. Key auction target — watch indirect bidder demand. Currently 4.36%.
30-Year Bond	FRED (1-day lag)	Longest duration. Most sensitive to long-term inflation expectations and supply. 30Y rising sharply = term premium building = Dalio warning. Currently 4.94%.

Fed Funds Rate (EFFR)	FRED (daily actual)	Actual overnight rate. Currently 3.50-3.75% target (hardcoded). 4 dissents at April 29 FOMC = most since 1992 = policy fracture signal. Next meeting June 16-17, 2026.
10Y TIPS Real Yield	FRED (daily)	Above 2% = restrictive real borrowing. 0-2% = neutral . Negative = financial repression = Fed monetizing = Dalio wealth transfer signal. Currently 1.94% — just below restrictive threshold.

AUCTIONS Tab

Treasury auctions are the most important real-time stress test for US debt sustainability. Unlike secondary market yields (reflecting trading), auctions show **actual primary demand** — foreign central banks, institutions, and dealers making real buying decisions on new US government debt.

Auction Metric Legends

Metric	GREEN	YELLOW	RED	Why It Matters
Bid-to-Cover (BTC) <i>Total bids ÷ amount offered</i>	> 2.50x	2.30-2.50x	< 2.30x	Low BTC = buyers scarce = debt getting harder to sell = monetization risk rising. Falling BTC trend over multiple auctions is a Dalio early warning.
Indirect Bidders % <i>Foreign central banks via Fed</i>	> 68%	62-68%	< 62%	Declining indirect = reserve diversification from USD = Dalio reserve currency pressure. Currently consistently below 62% threshold — active warning signal. This is a key metric to watch.
Dealer Takedown % <i>Primary</i>	< 14%	14-18%	> 18%	High dealer% = dealers forced to absorb what others didn't buy = inventory to sell into secondary market = yield pressure ahead. 2Y

<i>dealers absorbing remainder</i>				showing 30.4% = very elevated stress signal.
Tail (bp) <i>High yield minus when-issued yield</i>	< 0.5bp	0.5-1.0bp	> 1.0bp	Positive tail = buyers demanded MORE than market expected = surprise demand shock. Currently N/A — requires Interactive Brokers when-issued yield data (pending account approval).
Status Label	STRONG	MIXED	WEAK / PENDING	PENDING (grey) = Treasury has not yet published detailed bidder data for this auction — normal for recently completed auctions. Data typically published within 24-48 hours of auction close.

Auction Sort Order

Auctions displayed by maturity descending (standard bond market convention): **30Y → 10Y → 7Y → 5Y → 3Y → 2Y**. This mirrors the yield curve structure and makes steepening/inversion visible at a glance.

Current Auction Signals (as of May 2026)

Active Warning: 2Y Note — Dealer Takedown 30.4% (RED, far above 18% threshold). Indirect 58.3% (RED). Both indicate foreign buyers stepping back from 2Y auctions, forcing dealers to absorb. This is the front end of the yield curve — where US deficit financing pressure shows up first.

WEEKLY **Tab**

Fed Policy

Indicator	Current Value	Type	Signal Interpretation

Fed Funds Rate	3.50%-3.75%	Hardcoded	Target range. 4 dissents at April 29 meeting = most since October 1992 = policy fracture signal. Hawks want to hold, doves want to cut. Market sees ~6% chance of June cut.
Next Meeting	2026-06-16	Hardcoded	June 16-17, 2026. Update after each FOMC announcement.
Market Cut Prob (Jun)	6%	Hardcoded (CME)	CME FedWatch probability. Very low = market not pricing easing. Check CME FedWatch (cmegroup.com/markets/interest-rates/cme-fedwatch-tool) for live value.

Labor Market

Indicator	Green	Yellow	Red	Dalio Significance
Unemployment Rate	< 4.0%	4.0-5.0%	> 5.0% rising	Currently 4.3% — slightly above full employment. Rising trend = credit stress building = Dalio Stage 4 transition signal.
NFP (Non-Farm Payrolls)	> +150k/month	+50-150k	< 0 (job losses)	Currently +178k — still positive but below recent trend. Slowdown from prior month (-133k revision) shows volatility.
Initial Jobless Claims	< 220k	220-300k	> 300k sustained	Weekly leading indicator. Currently 189k = healthy. Fast rise above 250k would be early recession warning.
Continuing Claims	< 1.8M	1.8-2.5M	> 2.5M rising	Measures how long unemployed remain unemployed. Rising = harder to find new jobs = labor market weakening.

Inflation

--	--	--	--

Indicator	Source	Current	Signal Interpretation
CPI MoM	FRED/BLS monthly	+0.87%	Month-over-month change. +0.87% MoM annualizes to ~10.4% — very elevated. Fed 2% target implies ~+0.17% MoM. Above +0.4% = hot. Energy is major driver.
Core CPI MoM	FRED/BLS monthly	+0.2%	Excludes food and energy. More stable signal. +0.2% = annualizes ~2.4% = near target. Sticky core CPI prevents Fed from cutting despite other pressures.
PCE MoM	FRED/BEA monthly	+0.66%	Fed's preferred broader measure. Weights consumption differently from CPI. +0.66% MoM = hot. Energy drives headline.
Core PCE MoM	FRED/BEA monthly	+0.29%	Most important single inflation metric for Fed decisions. +0.29% MoM = annualizes ~3.5% = well above 2% target. Fed cannot cut while core PCE remains this elevated.

Economic Activity

Indicator	Source	Current	Signal Interpretation
GDP (annualized)	FRED/BEA quarterly	+2.0% Q1 2026	Positive = not in recession. Below +1% = stagnation risk. Q1 was above consensus. Prior quarter was +0.5% — improvement. GDP + sticky inflation = stagflation pressure, not outright stagflation.
Retail Sales	FRED/Census monthly	\$752.1B (+1.66% MoM)	Consumer spending health. Rising = consumer still strong despite higher rates. Falling for 2+ consecutive months = demand destruction signal.
10Y TIPS Real Yield	FRED daily	1.94%	Above 2% = restrictive real borrowing conditions. Currently 1.94% = approaching restrictive . Negative = financial repression = Dalio monetization in progress.

TIC Foreign Holdings (Changes shown are vs prior month)

Data source: US Treasury slt_table5.txt. Released ~45 days after month end. Latest: February 2026. March 2026 data due mid-May 2026.

Country	Feb 2026	MoM Change	Trend	Notes
Japan	\$1,239.3B	+\$14B ▲	Buying	Largest holder. Buys UST to support yen carry trade and reserves management.
United Kingdom	\$897.3B	+\$17.6B ▲	Rising	London is financial center/custody hub for European and global institutions.
China, Mainland	\$693.3B	-\$1.1B ▼	Selling	Long-term selling trend. Peak was \$1.3T (2013). Net -\$185B since 2021. Diversifying into gold and other assets.
Belgium	\$454.7B	+\$3.7B ▲	Buying	Euroclear custody hub — represents European institutional demand.
Canada	\$446.3B	+\$50.5B ▲	Buying strongly	Notable large purchase in Feb 2026.
Luxembourg	\$445.7B	-\$0.3B ▼	Flat	European financial center. Slight reduction.
Cayman Islands	\$443B	+\$10.2B ▲	Buying	Hedge fund custody hub — represents alternative investment demand.
France	\$395.1B	+\$14.6B ▲	Buying	Rising European sovereign demand.
TOTAL	\$9,487.1B		Stable/rising	Foreign share of US debt:

		+\$197.7B 		26.2%. Broadly stable. China trend is the key structural risk.
--	--	---	--	--

Fed Balance Sheet (H.4.1 – Weekly)

Item	Value (Apr 29)	Trend	Dalio Significance
Total Assets	\$6.70T	Declining slowly	Peak was \$8.9T (April 2022). QT reduced it. Still historically elevated = unresolved monetary expansion from COVID response.
Treasuries (SOMA)	\$4.43T	Declining	Fed's Treasury holdings = monetized debt. Passive QT via maturity runoff. If Fed resumes buying = QE = Dalio monetization lever activated.
MBS	\$1.98T	Declining slowly	Legacy mortgage-backed securities from QE. Very slow runoff — prepayment rates low at current mortgage rates.
Bank Reserves	\$2.92T	Stable	Excess reserves held at Fed. QT ended Dec 2025 at near operational minimum. Below \$2.5T = potential repo market stress.
Weekly Change	-\$7.5B	Near zero	QT effectively ended Dec 2025. Near-zero weekly change = balance sheet stabilizing at current level = reserve management phase.

Treasury Cash (TGA)

Treasury General Account — the US government's checking account at the Federal Reserve.
 Current: \$988.1B (prior month \$1,007.2B).

Level	Signal	Why It Matters
Above \$500B	Comfortable	Treasury has ample cash buffer. Low near-term issuance pressure.
\$200-500B	Monitor	Treasury will need to issue bonds soon to replenish. Watch upcoming auction sizes.

Below \$200B	Stress	Treasury must issue heavily immediately. Large supply = potential yield spike = Dalio auction stress signal.
-------------------------	---------------	--

Basis Trade / Repo Stress

Hedge funds buy cash Treasuries and sell futures, capturing the price differential. Estimated size: \$0.8T. When leveraged positions unwind (March 2020 precedent), repo markets seize and yields spike.

SOFR-Treasury Spread	Signal	Interpretation
< 10bp	Normal	Basis trade stable, repo markets functioning normally. Currently 8bp = low stress.
10-25bp	Elevated	Leverage building or unwinding. Monitor closely.
> 25bp or rapidly rising	Stress	Repo market stress. Potential Fed emergency intervention. Treasury market liquidity at risk.

QTR Tab

Earnings (Real Finnhub/SEC EDGAR Data)

BEAT = EPS actual > estimate. **MISS** = EPS actual < estimate. Beat/miss percentage shown.

Dalio lens: If Mag7 starts missing estimates, AI-driven productivity assumption in equity valuations is challenged. A broad tech miss cycle would signal 10-20% correction risk from current SPX ~7,300 levels.

Government Reports

Report	Current Value	Type	Significance
Fed Funds Rate	3.50-3.75%	Hardcoded	Update after each FOMC. 4 dissents = policy fracture risk.

GDP Q1 2026	+2.0% annualized	BEA advance estimate	Not in recession. Below trend. Stagflation = above-target inflation + below-trend growth.
Federal Deficit YTD	\$1.307T (through Mar 2026)	Hardcoded (Treasury)	On track for ~\$2T annual deficit. 7% of GDP = structural, not cyclical. Key Dalio monetization pressure driver.
Federal Debt Outstanding	\$38.9T	Hardcoded (Treasury)	Update monthly. Debt/GDP ~122% gross basis. Above all historical sustainability thresholds.
Debt-to-GDP	122%	Hardcoded (BEA/CBO)	Gross federal debt. Dalio: above 100% = debt service costs begin constraining policy. Above 120% = historically associated with monetization or restructuring.
Trade Balance	-\$60.3B (Mar 2026)	Hardcoded (BEA)	Goods and services deficit. Wide deficit = USD outflows to pay for imports = structural downward pressure on dollar over time.

INTEL

Tab

Uses Claude AI (claude-haiku-4-5-20251001) to generate a macro intelligence briefing anchored to live market data. Hit REFRESH for a fresh analysis. The briefing updates prices from the Daily tab when possible; otherwise uses verified hardcoded anchors.

Regime Classification Legend

Regime	Conditions	Typical Positioning
STAGFLATION 	Inflation above target + growth below trend simultaneously	Gold, commodities, short-duration bonds (TIPS), defensive equities, avoid long-duration nominal bonds
REFLATION 	Growth recovering, moderate inflation, policy easing	Risk assets, cyclicals, commodities, reduce cash
DEFLATION	Falling prices, weak	Long nominal bonds, cash, defensive quality

	growth, credit stress	equities
GOLDILOCKS 	Moderate growth, tame inflation, supportive policy	Equities broadly, credit, duration neutral
CRISIS 	Financial system stress, liquidity events	Cash, gold, short equities, government bonds (flight to safety)

Active Signal Colors

RED border = CRITICAL — Immediate attention, significant risk of near-term impact

YELLOW border = WARNING — Monitor closely, trend developing

BLUE border = WATCH — Emerging situation, not yet critical

Positioning Signal Interpretation

Asset	Signal Types	What It Means
USD	LONG / NEUTRAL / SHORT / FADE	Direction for dollar. SHORT = expect dollar to weaken vs G10. FADE = reduce existing long exposure over 12-month horizon as Fed cuts materialize.
GOLD	OVERWEIGHT / NEUTRAL / UNDERWEIGHT	Portfolio allocation vs benchmark. OVERWEIGHT = hold more gold than standard allocation. Target price range often included.
LONG BONDS	UNDERWEIGHT / OVERWEIGHT / AVOID	Duration exposure. UNDERWEIGHT 10Y = reduce 10-year Treasury exposure. PREFER TIPS = switch nominal bonds for inflation-linked.
EQUITIES	OVERWEIGHT / NEUTRAL / UNDERWEIGHT + bias	Equity allocation. QUALITY BIAS = favor profitable, low-leverage, dividend-paying companies. AVOID CYCLICALS = reduce consumer discretionary, industrials.

Big Cycle Lens — Key Concepts

- **Late-cycle:** Debt service costs rising, policy constrained, foreign buyers retreating, gold at ATH

- **Policy capitulation:** Fed forced to cut despite inflation = beginning of beautiful deleveraging
- **Multipolar reserve system:** USD losing exclusive reserve status, gold/alternatives rising
- **Bifurcated world:** US relatively resilient vs Eurozone/China entering deflationary pinch
- **Beautiful vs Ugly deleveraging:** Beautiful = 4 levers balanced, growth positive. Ugly = one lever dominates.

Ask a Macro Question — Example Questions

- What does weak auction demand signal for the dollar?
- How does China selling Treasuries affect US interest rates?
- What is the difference between QE and QT and where are we now?
- What does a 10% oil drop mean for inflation expectations?
- How does the basis trade affect Treasury market stability?
- What are the signals of a beautiful deleveraging beginning?
- How does the FOMC dissent count compare historically?